

# SOUBHAGYA SAHOO

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## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

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- Assistant Professor** [Dec 2023 – Present]  
Department of Theoretical Economics, Faculty of Economic Sciences, HSE University, Moscow Environment for Development (EfD), University of Gothenburg
- Junior Fellow** [Feb 2023 – Present]  
Center for research on the Economics of Climate, Food, Energy and Environment (CECFEE), Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi Center
- Visiting Assistant Professor** [Feb 2023 – Nov 2023]  
Center for research on the Economics of Climate, Food, Energy and Environment (CECFEE), Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi Center

## EDUCATION

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- Ph.D., Economics** [Aug 2017 – Jan 2023]  
Department of Economic Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur, India  
Thesis: *Essays in Experimental Economics*
- M.A., Economics** [Aug 2015 – May 2017]  
Center for Economic Studies and Planning, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India
- B.Tech., Mining Engineering** [Aug 2008 – Dec 2012]  
Department of Mining Engineering, National Institute of Technology Rourkela, India

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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**Major:** Experimental Economics, Behavioral Economics.

**Minor:** Economic Development, Labor Economics, Applied Micro-Economics.

## PUBLICATIONS

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### JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

1. “*Gender inequality and caste: Field experimental evidence from India*” with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Asad Islam, Liang Choon Wang and Yves Zenou (Monash University). Journal of Economic Behaviour and Organization, 2021, vol 190, 111-124.

### WORKING PAPERS

1. “*Informing the Job Search: A Field Experiment in an Urban Labor Market*” with Farzana Afridi (ISI Delhi) and Nikita Sangwan (Queen’s University, Belfast).
2. “*Rights, Resilience and Self-Defense: Experimental Evidence on Pathways to Empowerment Among Adolescent Girls in India*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Sarani Saha (IIT Kanpur), and Russell Smyth (Monash University). [Under Review, Draft available on request]
3. “*Smoke, Absence, and Chores: The Hidden Toll of Grandparental Loss on Indian Children*” with Arvind Mavliya (ISI Kolkata), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata) and Dil B. Rahut (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo). [Under Review, Draft available on request]

## WORK IN PROGRESS

1. “*Unintended consequences of Energy Subsidy: Evidence from India*” with Sarvesh Ingle (Ashoka University, Delhi NCR) and Sk Niyaj Mohammed (Shiv Nadar University, Delhi NCR).
2. “*Replacement or Autonomy? Parent-in-Law Death, Fertility Desires, and Maternal Well-Being in India*” with Arvind Mavliya (ISI Kolkata), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata) and Dil B. Rahut (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo).
3. “*Complementarities between Maternal Knowledge and Child Care Investment in Improving Child Health and Overall Development: Evidence from an Impact Evaluation in Indian Slums*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata).
4. “*Oil, War, and Rumour: Information Provision and Household Energy Insecurity During a Geopolitical Shock*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Ngawang Dendup (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo), Dil B. Rahut (Asian Development Bank Institute, Tokyo) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata).
5. “*Spirituality, Religiosity, and Locus of Control: Evidence from an endline survey on pathways to empowerment experiment among adolescent girls in India*” with Prasad Bhattacharya (Deakin University, Australia), Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata).
6. “*Accidents do not happen, they are caused: Experimental evidence on the traffic situation in India*” with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata) and Kaushiki Roy (ISI Kolkata).
7. “*Degrees over Dowry: Education as a Marriage Market Signal and Dowry Substitute in India*” with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Kaushiki Roy (ISI Kolkata) and Arpita Kundu (ISI Kolkata).
8. “*When Should You Quit? A Field Experiment on Family Disclosure, Social Norms, and Willingness to Compete*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Ngawang Dendup (ADBI, Tokyo), Dil B. Rahut (ADBI, Tokyo), Raja Rajendra Timilsina (ADBI, Tokyo) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata). [In design phase]
9. “*What Information Moves Willingness to Pay for Water Testing? Revealed Preference for Coliform, Chromium, and Lead Detection in Rural and Shum India*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Ngawang Dendup (ADBI, Tokyo), Dil B. Rahut (ADBI, Tokyo), Raja Rajendra Timilsina (ADBI, Tokyo) and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata). [In design phase]
10. “*AI-Based Legal Rights Awareness and Its Effects on Labour Force Participation, Financial Inclusion, and Confidence*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM Kozhikode), Dil B. Rahut (ADBI, Tokyo), and Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata). [In design phase]

## OPINION PIECES/BLOGS/MEDIA COLUMNS

1. “*Gender-caste intersectionality in discrimination: Do patients care about doctor’s social identity?*” with Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), Asad Islam, Liang Choon Wang and Yves Zenou (Monash University). **Ideas for India** [Publisher: International Growth Centre] (2021). [[English](#)] [[Hindi](#)]
2. “*Countering violence against women with awareness creation and self-defence training*” with Chitwan Lalji (IIM, Kozhikode), Debayan Pakrashi (ISI Kolkata), and Sarani Saha (IIT Kanpur). **Ideas for India** [Publisher: International Growth Centre] (2021). [[English](#)] [[Hindi](#)]

## CONFERENCES

1. Twentieth Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (ACEGD) [2025]  
Indian Statistical Institute (Delhi) (Presented by co-author).
2. Advances with Field Experiments Conference [2025]  
University of Chicago (Presented by co-author).
3. Irish Economic Association Annual Conference 2025 [2025]  
Queen’s University Belfast (Presented by co-author).
4. Wuhan University-HSE University Joint Workshop on Applied Economics [2025]  
Wuhan University, China.
5. Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES) [2023]  
Indian Institute of Technology Bombay.
6. Third Asian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (AWEHE) [2022]  
Miyagi, Japan.
7. Winter School 2022 [2022]  
Delhi School of Economics, New Delhi.
8. Behavioral Research in Economics Workshop - Economic Science Association (BREW-ESA) [2022]  
Indian Institute of Management Bangalore, India.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### TEACHING

Instructor, Faculty of Economic Sciences, HSE University, Moscow

- Behavioral Economics, *Undergraduate*. 2024, 2025, 2026.
- Behavioral Economics, *Graduate*. 2025, 2026 (4.73/5).
- Experimental Economics, *Graduate*. 2024, 2025 (4.49/5), 2026 (4.54/5).

*Teaching Ratings:*

| <i>Academic Year</i> | <i>Personal GPA</i> |
|----------------------|---------------------|
| 2025/2026            | 4.44/5              |
| 2024/2025            | 4.19/5              |
| 2023/2024            | 4.04/5              |

The Behavioral Economics course for Master's students in the 2025/2026 academic year received the following accolades from the University course page: *Best Course for Career Development*, *Best Course for Broadening Horizons and Diversity of Knowledge and Skills* and *Best Course for New Knowledge and Skills*.

Tutor, Department of Economic Sciences, IIT Kanpur

- Introduction to Economics (ECO101A), *Undergraduate*.  
Summer 2019, First Semester 2019, Summer 2021, First Semester 2021.
- Microeconomics: Theory & Applications, *Online Certification Course by NPTEL*.  
January-April 2020 & 2021.

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economic Sciences, IIT Kanpur

- Microeconomics I (ECO201A), *Undergraduate*, First Semester 2020.
- Development Economics (ECO311A), *Undergraduate*, Second Semester 2020, Second Semester 2021, Summer 2021, Second Semester 2022.
- Behavioral & Experimental Economics (ECO506A), *Undergraduate*, Summer 2021.  
Development Economics (ECO735A), *Graduate*, Second Semester 2021.

### SUPERVISION

1. Baatiekuu Enoch Naanyaan (Master's) [2024-2026]  
Thesis: The Daughter Effect: How Does the Birth of a Girl Affect the Empowerment and Agency of Mothers in India
2. Nikolai Sapega (Master's) [2025-2026]  
Thesis: Justice Sensitivity as a Moderator of Reciprocity in Two-Stage Games

## FELLOWSHIP AND GRANTS

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1. ADBI Grant (\$10,000) for Research Project (Co-PI): "Informal Economy, Aspiration for Higher Income Status, and Quality Growth: Implication for the Bottom Billions" [2026]  
Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
2. ADBI Grant (\$3,000) for Research Project (PI): "Cost Pass-Through of Iran War Oil Supply Shock (Implication on Asia's Prosperity with Quality Growth)" [2026]  
Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
3. ADBI Grant (\$10,000) for Research Project (Co-PI): "Know your rights with AI" [2026]  
Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
4. ADBI Grant (\$10,000) for Research Project (PI): "Revealed Preference for Water Quality Infrastructure in Rural and Urban Slum India" [2026]  
Asian Development Bank Institute (ADBI), Tokyo
5. RGHI Innovation Grant (\$106,000) for Research Project (Co-PI): "Sustainability of hygiene behaviours in Indian slums" [2024]  
Reckitt Global Hygiene Institute, New Jersey

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 6. National Conference Travel Grant, IIT Kanpur                                         | [2023]    |
| 7. 17th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development Travel Grant, ISI Delhi    | [2022]    |
| 8. National Conference Travel Grant, IIT Kanpur                                         | [2022]    |
| 9. Behavioral Research in Economics Workshop Travel Grant, IIM Bangalore                | [2022]    |
| 10. International Conference Travel Grant, IIT Kanpur                                   | [2022]    |
| 11. Asian Workshop on Econometrics and Health Economics (Japan) Conference Travel Grant | [2022]    |
| 12. Doctoral Fellowship (SRF), IIT Kanpur                                               | [2019-22] |
| 13. Doctoral Fellowship (JRF), IIT Kanpur                                               | [2017-19] |

## SOFTWARE SKILLS

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STATA, Python (Basic), MS-Excel, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X.

## PERSONAL INFORMATION

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**Birth date:** 15 January 1990

**Nationality:** Indian

**Gender:** Male

**Marital status:** Married

**Languages:** English (proficient), Odia (native), Hindi (fluent)

## REFERENCE

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*Available on Request.*